

2005. Its relentless focus on patenting has resulted in it having 8100 issued patents and 4200 pending patents in 100 countries, as of 2017.

Dolby also works with its customers to ensure there are no design mistakes in its products and that it is of high quality. One of the key decisions that Dolby has taken is to keep Dolby licensing affordable, so companies would rather use the technology than not. This has made the technology accessible and available everywhere, and kept competition out to a large extent. This has prevented it from being substituted by DTS. Even though it lost out to DTS initially, it managed to make a comeback.

The bottom line

Both products, before they decided to build an ingredient brand, belonged to commoditised categories. It always



Fig. 7: Dolby theatre

takes a bold mindset on someone's part to make moves like these. Dolby and Intel both built their brands with the end user of the finished products that their products go into, so that there is pull for the brands.

Intel provided funds to its customers' marketing budgets, which built loyalty and prevented substitution.

And, Dolby made licensing affordable, and made sure the technology was great. This is what prevented

others from dominating and for them to come back in the race.

Principles followed by the cases in this article can be used by many businesses:

1. To create partnerships with customers
2. To focus on product—innovating to make yourself redundant, so no one else does

3. To recognise the stage your product is at, and identify whether education is needed or competitive communication

4. To look out for new technologies and to not miss them out, like Dolby did with digital

5. To use topical happenings or big moments in your industry to your advantage, as these can be big inflection points in your industry—the way Dolby did with *Star Wars*

Part 2 of this article will explore more such examples. **EFY**

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